

Maxime Solaire

Senior Unity Engineer & Technical Lead

Gameplay Programmer specializing in **real-time rendering systems**, **gameplay architecture**, and **technical leadership**. **10+ years Unity** with deep expertise in C#, HLSL, and high-performance systems.

EDUCATION

Master of Science - Image & Sound Processing |
University of Bordeaux | **2014** (*With Honors*)
Bachelor of Science - Computer Science | University
of Bordeaux | **2012**

SHIPPED GAMES

Orphan Age (EA 2018-2024)
Click of Cthulhu (2020)
Yrminsul (2016)
Escape Light (2015)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Executive Producer @ Studio Black Flag | Dec 2022 - July 2024

Bordeaux, France | Hands-on leadership with continued technical contributions

Technical Contributions (Hands-on)

- **Optimized lighting & mesh systems**, achieving 4-5x FPS improvement only with the lighting
- **Created in-game bug reporting and feedback system** with Trello API integration (later migrated to ClickUp API)

Production Leadership

- **Grew from sole engineer to executive leadership**, combining technical expertise with business development and team management throughout an 8+ year journey at Studio Black Flag
- **Led a cross-functional team of 15-20+ people** (employees and freelancers, junior to senior): recruitment, onboarding, production planning, cash flow, mediation, tasks attribution and review.
- **Managed strategic relationships** with publisher (Ubisoft) and VC investor (Global Top Round): Led creative direction overhaul, restructured production plan and deliverables, reporting, negotiations, and securing contract renewal at no additional cost

Unity Engineer / Lead Unity Engineer @ Studio Black Flag | Oct 2015 - Dec 2022

Bordeaux, France | Scaled from 2-person team to 18-person studio

Gameplay & Tools Programming

- **Core engineer on Orphan Age** from concept to production. Built foundational systems: AI, UI, save/load, localization, core loops
- **Migrated codebase to Addressables**, reducing startup time and enabling scalable asset management for DLC-ready architecture
- **Designed and built Quest Editor tool** enabling designers to create in-game quests without programming
- **Built Google Sheets → Unity integration** for in-engine design data access
- **Developed custom multi-color outline system** in HDRP render pipeline using screen-space techniques ([technical writeup](#))

CI/CD & Infrastructure

- **Architected and maintained self-hosted CI/CD pipeline**: server hardware + Docker infrastructure via Portainer (Gitea + Drone + custom bots)

Business Development & Strategy

- **Pitched to Ubisoft at Gamescom 2018** (B2B), initiating the publishing relationship that led to the deal
- **Awarded a place in GTR accelerator partnership** (top 10 of 500 projects) in Busan in 2019, bringing strategic investment and production support
- **Negotiated and signed** a multi million € publishing contract with Ubisoft Open Innovation (December 2020)

Unity Developer (Solo) | Sep 2014 - Oct 2015

Roma, Italia

Development

- **Developed complete mobile game solo**: gameplay programming, UI/UX implementation, and technical optimization for Android
- **Built custom puzzle mechanics** and level progression system

Design & Publishing

- **Managed full product lifecycle**: game design, art direction, and market release strategy
- **Published on Google Play Store**: handled store page creation, asset preparation, and post-launch monitoring

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

CONTACT

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TECHNICAL SKILLS & SHIPPED GAMES

Technical Stack

Unity - 10 years

Unreal Engine - 1 year

C# / .NET - 10 years

HLSL - 3 years

C++ - 1 year

Blueprint - 1 year

Git - 6 years

Docker / Portainer - 5 years

Gitea & Drone CI - 3 years

Shipped Games

[Orphan Age](#)

Survival Management Sim | PC - Steam (EA 2018-2024) | Unity 5->2023

[Click of Cthulhu](#)

City Builder Idle Clicker | PC - itch.io (2020) | Unity 2019

[Yrminsul](#)

Tower Defense | PC - Steam (2016) | Unity 4.6

Escape Light

Mobile Puzzle Game | Android - Play Store (2015) | Unity 4.6

PERSONAL & PROJECTS

Recent Projects

PAGI (PixelArt Global Illumination) [2026]

Custom GI system for 2D pixel art with SDF + raymarching rendering

Unity, C#, HLSL, Compute Shaders, Jump Flood Algorithm

Unity-DDGI [2024]

Dynamic Diffuse Global Illumination with raytraced irradiance probes

Unity, C#, HLSL, Compute Shaders, Raytracing

smart-rex-c100 [2025]

IoT hardware hack: WiFi-enabled PID controller via ESP32

C++, ESP32, HTML/CSS/JS, IoT

Gaming Interests

Survival/Management: DayZ, Frostpunk 1 & 2, The Alters

Narrative/Indie: What Remains of Edith Finch

Technical showcases: MIO (Memory in Orbit) - shaders

Hobbies

Hardware tinkering: IoT projects, ESP32 hacking

Silversmithing: Jewelry & metalwork crafting

Home cultivation: Fermentation & mushroom growing

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Best Game

[Game For a Cause](#) - *[Hoodie Hitchhike](#)*

Worldwide - oct 2025

Innovation in Games Award

[Ludicrous Festival](#) - *[Orphan Age](#)*

Zurich, Switzerland - jan 2019

Jury Prize - Best Indie Game

[Stunfest](#) - *[Orphan Age](#)*

Rennes, France - may 2018

SOFT SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Cross-functional Leadership

Led teams of 15-20+ (junior to senior)

Technical Problem-Solving

Complex systems architecture & optimization

Business Acumen

Contract negotiation, investor relations

French - Native

English - Proficient